

Two tasks, one item-level comparison

Qwen3.5-9B · 595 target items

a Continuation

Three matched contextual prefixes

- **M** We caught the bus back
- **A** We took the bus back
- **I** We grabbed the bus back

M: original · A: apt · I: inapt

Prefix ends after 3 shared post-target words



Sample short continuations

32 samples × 3 seeds · 5 tokens each

$$\Delta_i = d_i(M, I) - d_i(M, A)$$

Positive Δ : metaphor continuations are closer to A

b Explicit judgement

Matched context

We [TARGET: caught] the bus back

Word only

[TARGET: caught]

Candidates: took (apt) / grabbed (inapt)

Same question and A/B responses; both option orders



Apt-minus-inapt log response probability

$$S_{\text{context}, i} \quad \text{and} \quad S_{\text{word}, i}$$

$$C_i = S_{\text{context}, i} - S_{\text{word}, i}$$

Context-linked change in explicit preference



RQ2 · Combine scores from the same 595 target items

M0 Overall association

Δ with contextual preference S_{context}

M1 Conditional association

Δ with C , accounting for S_{word}